SHORT · DATAFRAME

What is a Spark DataFrame?

A Spark DataFrame organizes data into rows and named columns.

Key points

- Picture a customer list: a name column, a city column, and one row per customer.
- Create it in a Databricks notebook with Python. A variable such as customers refers to that DataFrame.
- select describes a transformation. show asks Spark to produce a result.
- A DataFrame is not automatically a saved table. Save it separately if you need to keep the data.

Tiny example

Two customer rows, then select and show. Angle brackets are placeholders. No live printout is recorded here.

```
customers = spark.createDataFrame(
    [("<name>", "<city>"), ("<name>", "<city>")],
    ["name", "city"],
)
customers.select("name").show()
```

Misconception check

> select does not by itself print or save anything. show produces a result. The customers variable is still not a saved table.

Remember

A DataFrame is a way to work with rows and columns using code.

The Short says you can try this tiny example in Databricks Free Edition.